

COMMANDS OF JESUS

Prayer and Fasting

A teaching framework for dependence, spiritual hunger, and breakthrough.

Core idea: prayer and fasting align the heart with God and deepen dependence on Him.

TEACHING 01

The Call to Pray

KEY SCRIPTURES

- Luke 18:1 *"They should always pray and not give up."*
- 1 Thessalonians 5:17 *"Pray without ceasing."*
- Matthew 6:6 *"When you pray, go into your room, close the door and pray to your Father..."*

KEY IDEA

- Prayer is not a religious activity.
- It is relationship with God.
- Jesus assumed we would pray. He said when you pray, not if you pray.
- Prayer aligns our hearts with God's will.
- It invites His power into our weakness.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **How would you describe your current prayer life?**
2. **Is prayer your first response or your last resort?**
3. **What keeps you from consistent prayer?**

TEACHING 02

How Jesus Taught Us to Pray

KEY SCRIPTURES

- Matthew 6:9-13 *The Lord's Prayer*
- Luke 11:1 *"Lord, teach us to pray."*
- Mark 1:35 *"Very early in the morning... Jesus went off to a solitary place, where He prayed."*

KEY IDEA

- Jesus modeled:
 - Private prayer
 - Consistent prayer
 - Early prayer
 - Surrendered prayer The Lord's Prayer shows us:
- Honor the Father
- Seek His kingdom

- Ask for daily provision
- Confess sin
- Forgive others
- Ask for protection Prayer is worship, dependence, repentance, and surrender.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **What part of the Lord's Prayer stands out most to you?**
2. **When is your most focused time of prayer?**
3. **What would change if you scheduled prayer intentionally?**

TEACHING 03

The Power of Fasting

KEY SCRIPTURES

- *Matthew 6:16-18 "When you fast..."*
- *Acts 13:2-3 "While they were worshiping the Lord and fasting..."*
- *Joel 2:12 "Return to Me with all your heart, with fasting..."*

KEY IDEA

Fasting is voluntarily denying the flesh to seek God more fully.

- It humbles the soul.
- It sharpens spiritual sensitivity.
- It increases focus and desperation for God. Jesus assumed we would fast. He said when you fast, not if you fast. Fasting is not about earning God's favor. It is about positioning your heart before Him.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **Have you ever fasted intentionally? Why or why not?**
2. **What fears or misconceptions do people have about fasting?**
3. **What might God do in your life if you fasted regularly?**

TEACHING 04

Why Prayer and Fasting Go Together

KEY SCRIPTURES

- Ezra 8:23 "So we fasted and petitioned our God about this, and He answered our prayer."
- Mark 9:29 "This kind can come out only by prayer."

KEY IDEA

- Prayer invites God's presence.
- Fasting intensifies our dependence.
- Throughout Scripture, breakthrough moments often followed prayer and fasting.
- The early church fasted before major decisions.
- Jesus fasted before launching His ministry.
- Prayer and fasting prepare the heart for clarity, power, and obedience.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **What decision in your life needs prayer and fasting?**
2. **Do you seek comfort or breakthrough?**
3. **What would it look like to fast before major steps of obedience?**

TEACHING 05

Heart Check

KEY SCRIPTURES

- James 4:8 "Draw near to God and He will draw near to you."
- Psalm 51:17 "A broken and contrite heart You will not despise."

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

1. **Do I hunger for God more than I hunger for comfort?**
2. **What distractions are dulling my spiritual appetite?**
3. **When was the last time I sought God with intensity?**

TEACHING 06

Practical Prayer and Fasting Plan

- Set a consistent daily prayer time.
- Use the Lord's Prayer as a framework.
- Fast one meal, one day, or longer as led by the Lord.
- Replace eating time with prayer and Scripture.

- Fast with humility, not announcement.
- Journal what God speaks.

PERSONAL ACTION QUESTIONS

1. **What time each day will I devote to focused prayer?**
2. **When will I fast next?**
3. **What specific burden or breakthrough am I seeking God for?**
4. **Who can join me in prayer and fasting?**

TEACHING 07

Closing Prayer Prompt

PRAYER PROMPT

Father, teach me to pray. Create in me a hunger for You. Help me lay down comfort so I can seek You more deeply. Align my heart with Your will. Let prayer and fasting shape my life and prepare me for obedience. Amen.